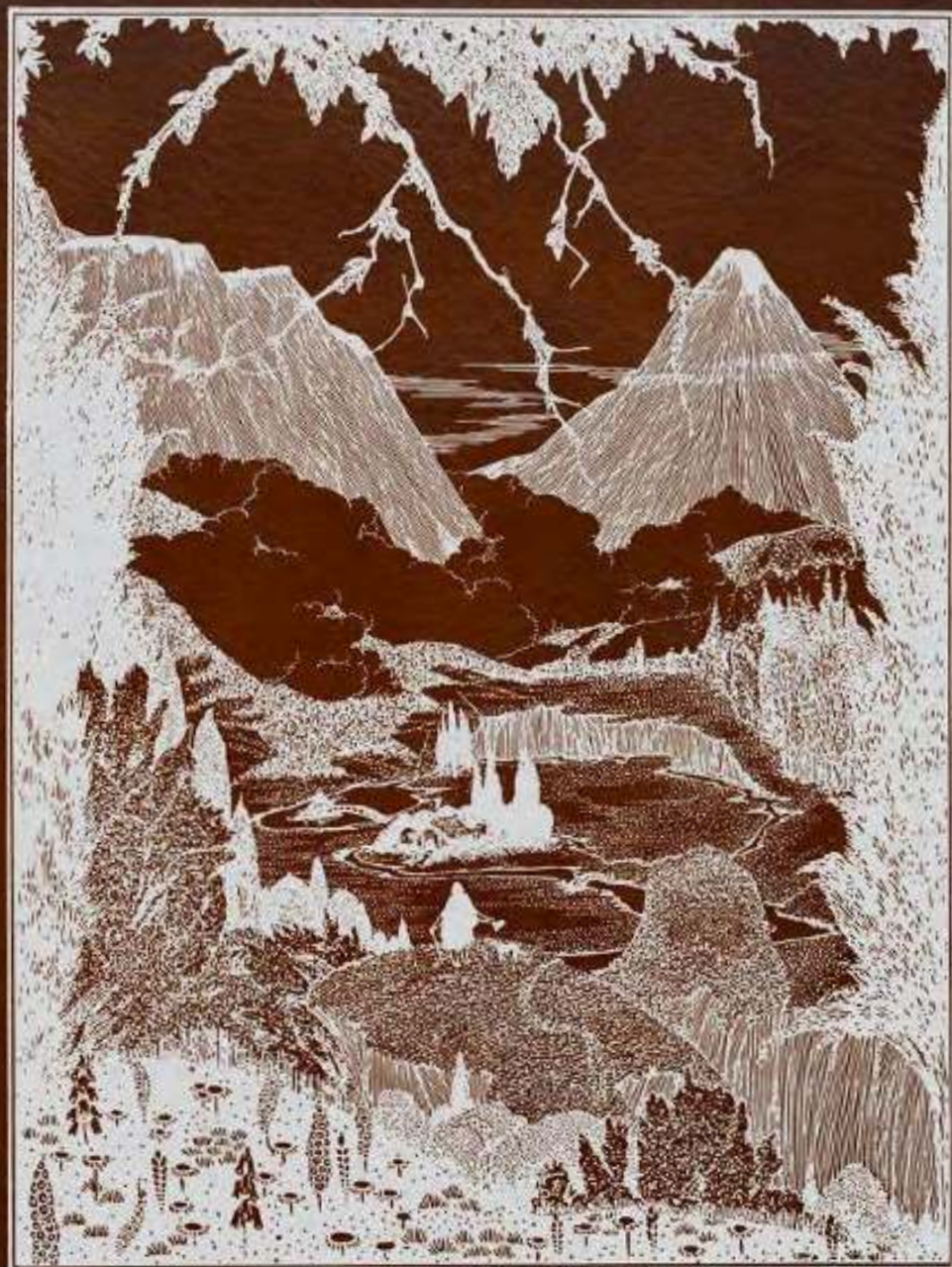


WEST MARCHES

GAME MASTER WORKBOOK



KARL OTTO KRISTOFFERSEN

WEST MARCHES

GAME MASTER WORKBOOK



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Typography for this project includes CS Roger, Bright and Open Sans

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Feedback are most welcome, thank you for the comments so far!

Change Log:

Version 1.0 - 18.09.2025: First release of PDF version -- edits to be expected



FOREWORD

This workbook is your companion to the West Marches Guidebook.

Where the guidebook teaches you the playstyle, this gives you the space to run it. Here you can track your world, players, and expeditions, one session at a time.

Every page is designed to keep your notes clear, your world consistent, and your table ready for the next adventure.

How to use it:

1. **Keep it close during play.** Bring it to every session. Write down what happens, and how the world changes.
2. **Log what matters.** NPCs, factions, rumors, quests, maps, and more. Even small details can grow into big adventures.
3. **Update between sessions.** Fill in Session Logs, and track time as Events or in the Calendar.
4. **Make it yours.** Mark key pages with tabs, or add extra sheets where you need more space.

Good luck, and enjoy!

Karl Otto Kristoffersen

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PART 1: CAMPAIGN OVERVIEW

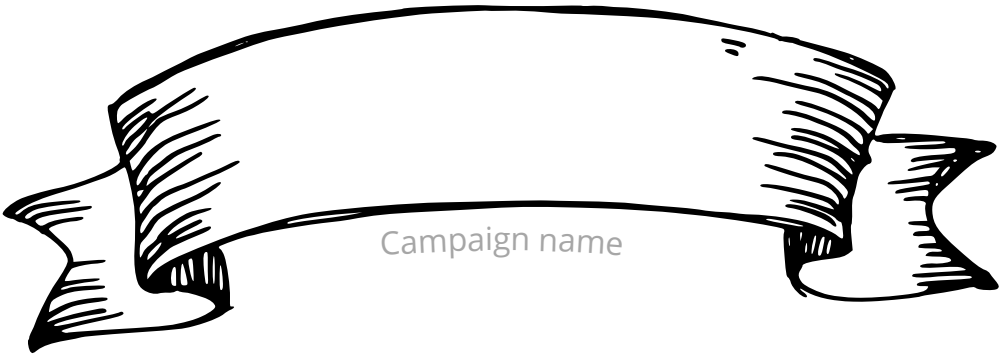
This part is your campaign's compass. It's a quick reference to keep tone, scope, and style consistent from session to session, even when events go wild.

Write down the broad strokes so everyone knows what kind of world they're stepping into and what to expect. Keep it short, clear, and inspiring

- **Campaign Name:** A title that grabs attention
- **Home Base:** Where the party starts and returns to
- **The World:** A short snapshot of the setting
- **Tone:** Capture the mood
- **The Hook:** What makes this campaign exciting
- **System:** The rules you're using
- **Lines & Veils:** Agreed boundaries for safe play
- **Notes:** Extra details, table rules, or reminders



WELCOME TO:



Home Base:

The World:

Tone:

The Hook:

System:

Lines & Veils:

Notes:

PART 2:

PLAYER ROSTER

Track who's playing, who they're playing, and what matters to them. This lets you build the world around the players' stories.

Example:

Player: Silje

Name: Mira "Fox" Rell

Class: Scout

Traits: Cautious, loyal, observant

Goals: Recover her father from the Brambledeep forest

Bonds: Hates Captain Varn (guard); looks up to her father Thram

Gear: Longbow, map case, half-broken compass

Notes: Thinks her fathers adventuring party may have been killed

Player 1

Name:

Class:

Traits:

Goals:

Bonds:

Gear:

Notes:





Player 2

Name:

Class:

Traits:

Goals:

Bonds:

Gear:

Notes:

Player 3

Name:

Class:

Traits:

Goals:

Bonds:

Gear:

Notes:

Player 4

Name:

Class:

Traits:

Goals:

Bonds:

Gear:

Notes:

Player 5

Name:

Class:

Traits:

Goals:

Bonds:

Gear:

Notes:

Player 6

Name:

Class:

Traits:

Goals:

Bonds:

Gear:

Notes:

Player 7

Name:

Class:

Traits:

Goals:

Bonds:

Gear:

Notes:

Player 8

Name:

Class:

Traits:

Goals:

Bonds:

Gear:

Notes:

Player 9

Name:

Class:

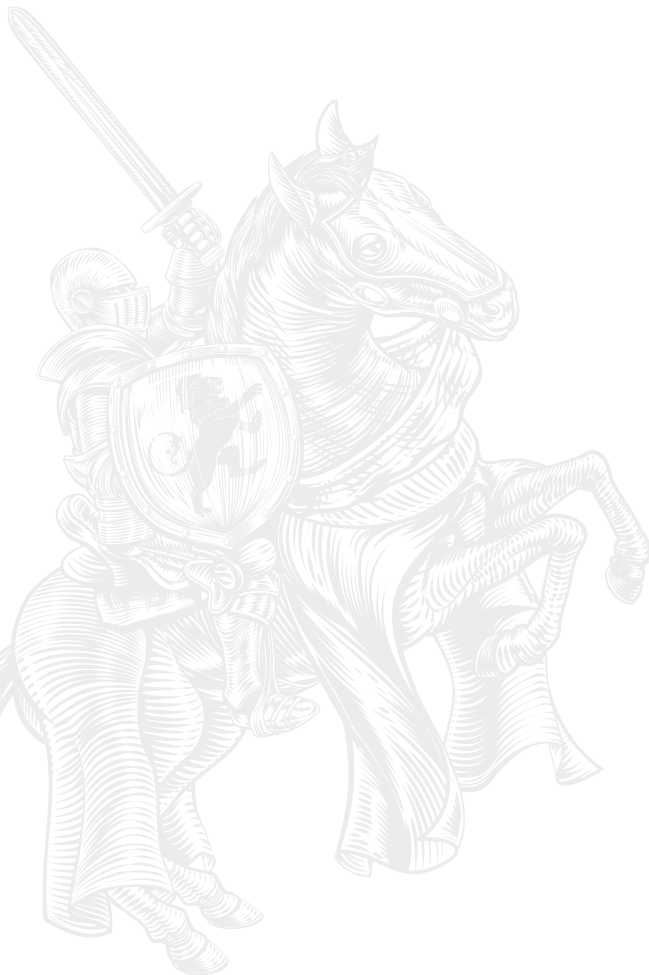
Traits:

Goals:

Bonds:

Gear:

Notes:



Player 10

Name:

Class:

Traits:

Goals:

Bonds:

Gear:

Notes:

Player 11

Name:

Class:

Traits:

Goals:

Bonds:

Gear:

Notes:

Player 12

Name:

Class:

Traits:

Goals:

Bonds:

Gear:

Notes:



PART 3:

HOME BASE

The home base is your campaign safe haven, a hub of rumors, and a launch point for every expedition. Use this page to outline the town's features, people, and sparks of adventure.

- **Name:** What's the settlement called?
- **Type:** Village, town, fort, camp, etc.
- **Population:** How many people live here?
- **Known For:** Unique goods, skills, landmarks, or traditions.
- **Key NPCs:** Notable figures the PCs will likely meet.
- **Services:** Places to trade, repair, or restock.
- **Factions:** Groups or powers with influence here.
- **Rumors:** Local whispers, news, or half-truths.
- **Notes:** Distinctive atmosphere, sounds, smells, or tensions.

Example:

Name: Stonehearth

Type: Walled frontier town

Population: Around 300

Known For: Goat cheese, black powder, silver mining

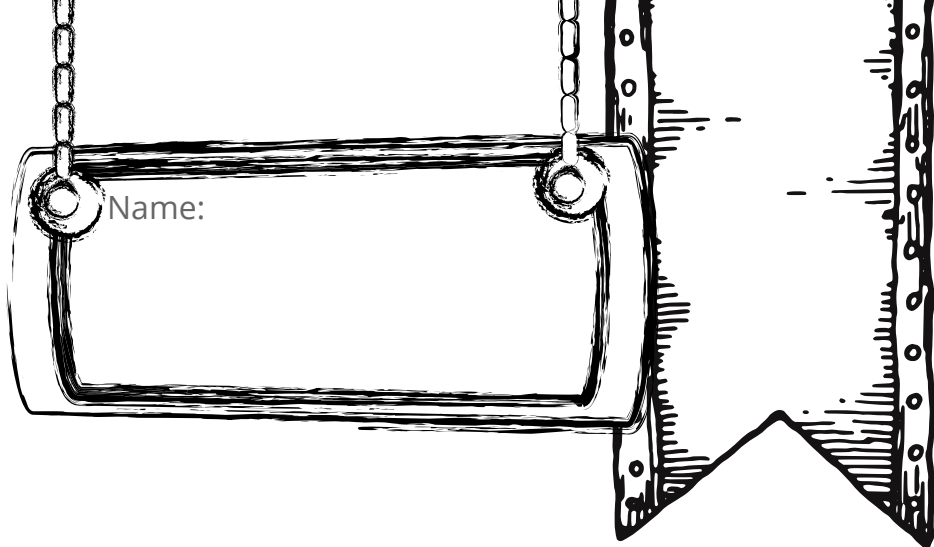
Key NPCs: Hyk (elder), Grima (apothecary), Varn (guard captain)

Services: Smithy, general store, apothecary, tavern, temple, cartographer's booth

Factions: Town Guard, Veil Seekers, Silver Syndicate

Rumors: Whispers of a cleansing fire amongst the poor

Notes: Goats everywhere



Type:

Population:

Known For:

Key NPCs:

Services:

Factions:

Rumors:

Notes:

PART 4:

THE WORLD

Make a simple map of the world outside your home base. Think of it as a sketch, not a finished artwork. Focus on areas of interest, not exact roads or measurements.

You don't need drawing skills. Use simple shapes and symbols to show important places. Your mind will fill in the blanks.

● **Circle** = Settlements, camps, or shrines

♣ **Clubs** = Forests or woods

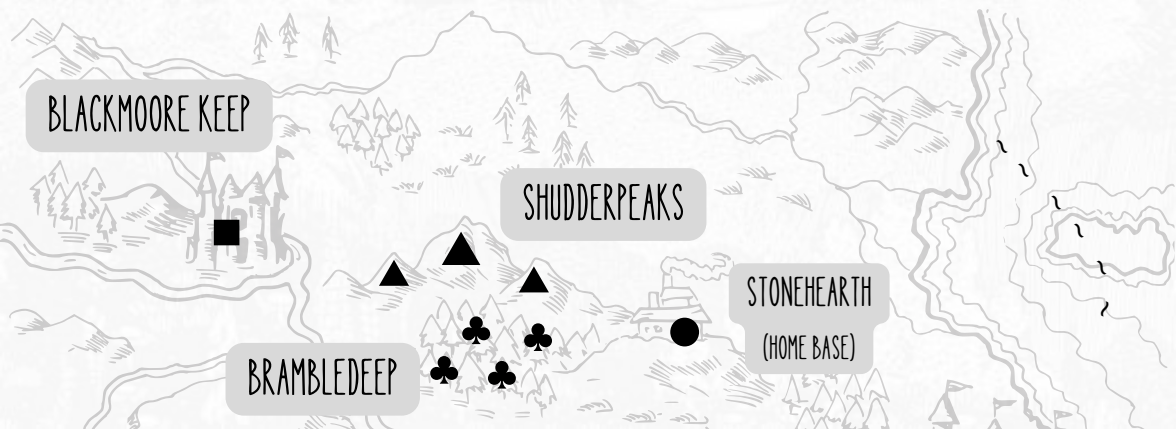
■ **Square** = Ruins or dungeons

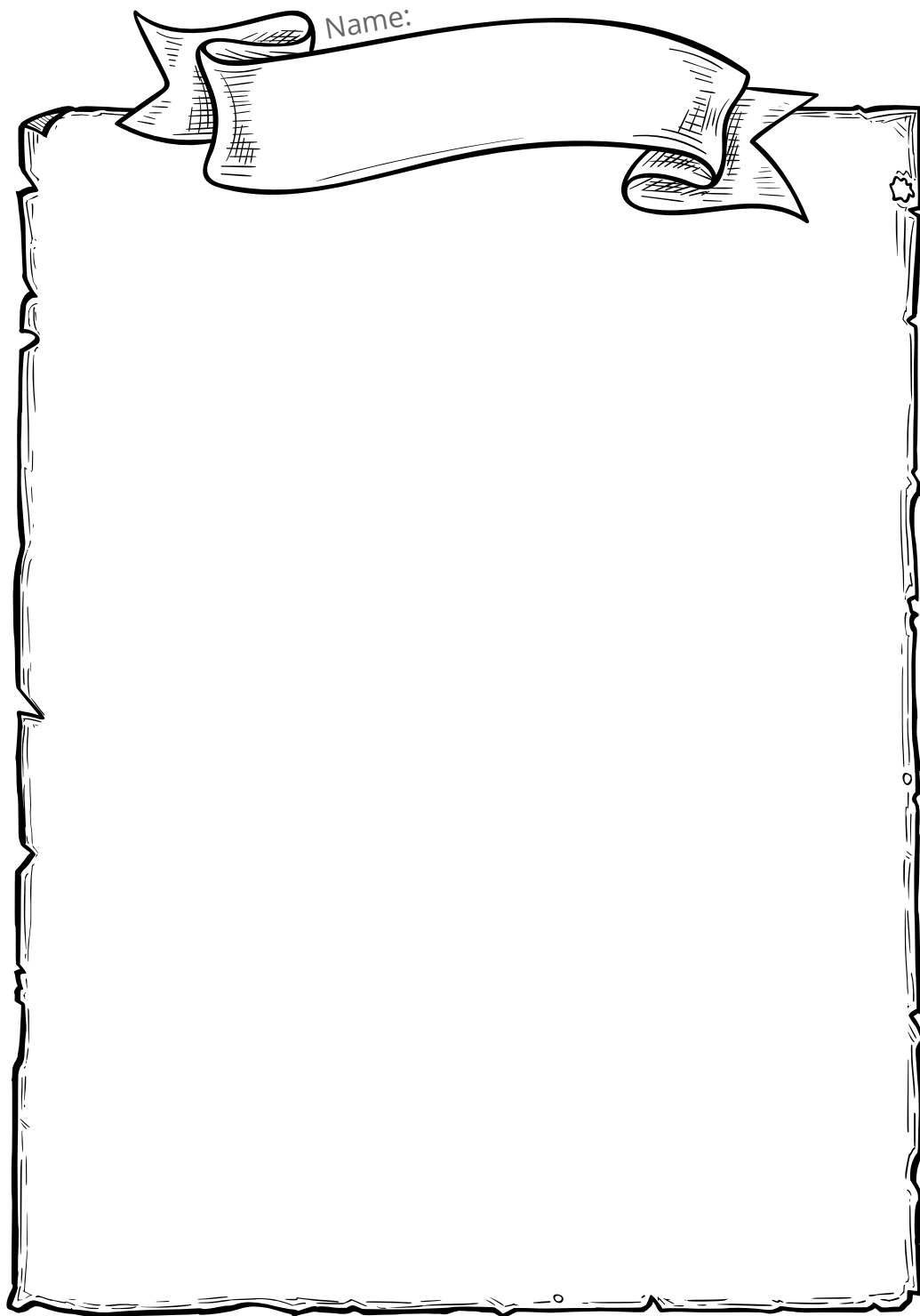
▲ **Triangle** = Mountains or towers

~ **Wavy line** = River or coastline

Tips:

- Start with the home base and sketch outward
- Add a few forests, hills, lakes, or ruins
- Leave space blank, let the players discover the rest
- Use numbers or names to reference locations later





PART 5:

LOCATIONS

Use this structure to sketch nearby areas your players might explore. Don't overthink the details, just note what makes each place feel interesting, mysterious, or dangerous. You'll flesh things out naturally during play.

Tie in factions, rumors, quests or events where it makes sense. These entries help grow your world into a web of leads, choices, and consequences.

- **Name:** What's it called?
- **Travel:** How far and in which direction?
- **Terrain:** Forest, mountain, swamp, ruins, etc
- **Atmosphere:** What does it feel like?
- **Points of Interest:** Places worth finding
- **Dangers:** Hazards, creatures, traps, curses
- **Inhabitants:** Ambient life, animals, citizens, spirits
- **Factions:** Who's active here? (hostile, neutral, friendly)
- **NPCs:** Named figures tied to the location
- **Rumors:** What people say about this place
- **Quests:** Reasons to go there
- **Discoverables:** Small finds like clues or treasure
- **Event:** Ties to a larger threat or unfolding force
- **Notes:** Extra flavor, weirdness, or complications

Example:



Name: Brambledeep

Travel: 2 days southwest

Terrain: Thorn-choked woods and shadowed trails

Atmosphere: Oppressive stillness, muffled sounds, claustrophobic

Points of Interest: Overgrown shrine, hidden whispering glade

Dangers: Brambles trap the unwary, wards may trigger,

Inhabitants: Deer, rabbits, wolves, birds that mimic voices

Factions: Secretive druids guarding forgotten places (hostile)

NPCs: Elder Moss, a ragged hermit who speaks in riddles

Rumors: "A ghost with antlers guards the shrine" (it's the druids)

Quests: Find a missing scouting party

Discoverables: Warding stones, antler talismans, map fragment

Event: The druids prepare to seize more territory

Notes: Paths twist unexpectedly at night, maps are unreliable

Location 1

Name:

Travel:

Terrain:

Atmosphere:

Points of Interest:

Dangers:

Inhabitants:

Factions:

NPCs:

Rumors:

Quests:

Discoverables:

Event:

Notes:

Location 2

Name:

Travel:

Terrain:

Atmosphere:

Points of Interest:

Dangers:

Inhabitants:

Factions:

NPCs:

Rumors:

Quests:

Discoverables:

Event:

Notes:

Location 3

Name:

Travel:

Terrain:

Atmosphere:

Points of Interest:

Dangers:

Inhabitants:

Factions:

NPCs:

Rumors:

Quests:

Discoverables:

Event:

Notes:



Location 4

Name:

Travel:

Terrain:

Atmosphere:

Points of Interest:

Dangers:

Inhabitants:

Factions:

NPCs:

Rumors:

Quests:

Discoverables:

Event:

Notes:

Location 5

Name:

Travel:

Terrain:

Atmosphere:

Points of Interest:

Dangers:

Inhabitants:

Factions:

NPCs:

Rumors:

Quests:

Discoverables:

Event:

Notes:



Location 8

Name:

Travel:

Terrain:

Atmosphere:

Points of Interest:

Dangers:

Inhabitants:

Factions:

NPCs:

Rumors:

Quests:

Discoverables:

Event:

Notes:

Location 9

Name:

Travel:

Terrain:

Atmosphere:

Points of Interest:

Dangers:

Inhabitants:

Factions:

NPCs:

Rumors:

Quests:

Discoverables:

Event:

Notes:

PART 6:

EVENTS

Track evolving threats, shifting powers, and world-changing forces. They escalate and react to player actions. Use checkboxes to mark progress and trigger consequences. Each event includes:

- **Name:** A short evocative title
- **Description:** What's emerging or spreading
- **Escalation:** How it worsens step by step
- **Triggers:** What advances it
- **Intercept:** How players can notice or stop it

Example:

Name: The Emberwake Plague

Description: A fever spreads from the Shudderpeaks. Most die, lungs scorched and veins blackened. But some survive, now driven by whispers of flame. A preacher vows the Fire will cleanse the world.

Escalation:

- ☒ *Burned corpses appear along mountain trails*
- ☒ *A remote village begins fire baptisms to "purify" the sick*
- ☐ *A mass ignition is planned atop a peak to awaken the Flame*

Triggers:

- ☒ *A week passes without interference*
- ☐ *The preacher speaks in a settlement*
- ☒ *Fire baptisms are allowed to continue*

Intercept:

- ☐ *Destroy the ancient flame idol hidden in the peaks*
- ☐ *Silence the preacher*
- ☐ *Cure or rescue villagers before they convert*

Event 1

Name:

Description:

Escalation:

☐☐☐

Triggers:

☐☐☐

Intercept:

☐☐☐

Event 2

Name:

Description:

Escalation:

☐☐☐

Triggers:

☐☐☐

Intercept:

☐☐☐

Event 3

Name:

Description:

Escalation:

☐☐☐

Triggers:

☐☐☐

Intercept:

☐☐☐

Event 4

Name:

Description:

Escalation:

☐☐☐

Triggers:

☐☐☐

Intercept:

☐☐☐

Event 5

Name:

Description:

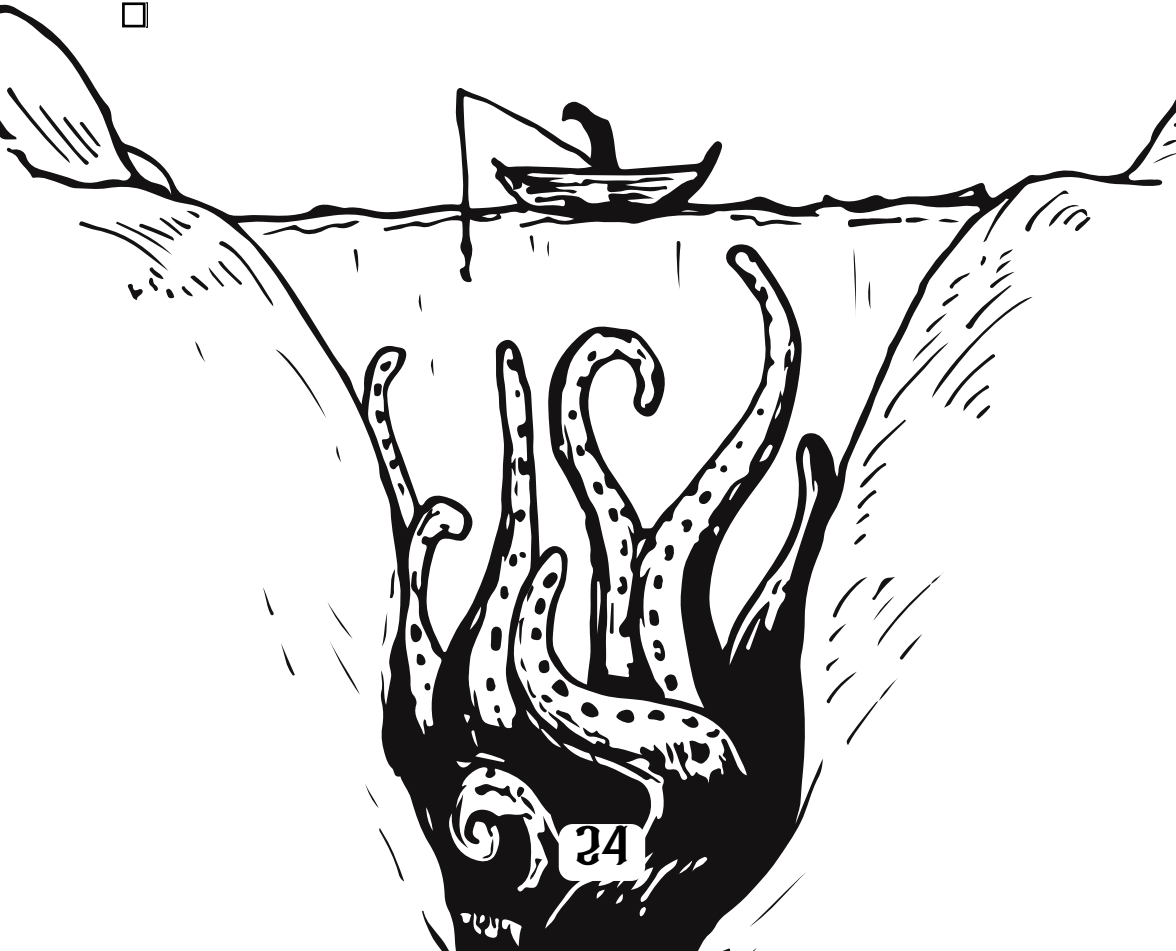
Escalation:

☐☐☐

Triggers:

☐☐☐

Intercept:

☐☐☐

PART 7:

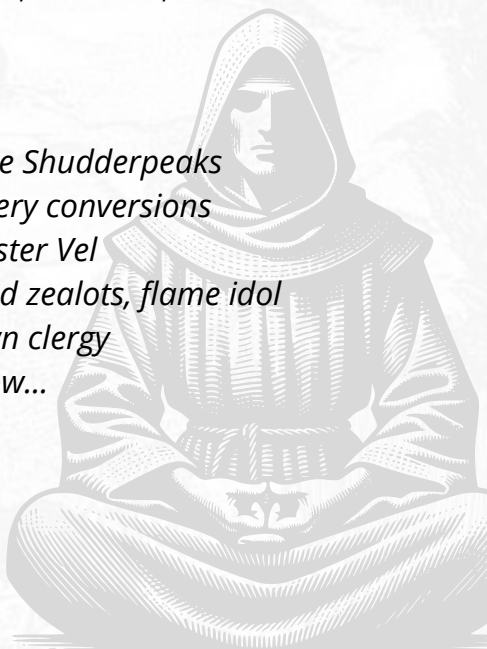
FACTIONS

Track the people and powers behind the scenes. Factions shape the world's politics, conspiracies, and open conflicts. Use this part to outline each group's motives, methods, and key characters. Each faction entry has:

- **Name:** Who are they?
- **Goals:** What do they want or believe in?
- **Methods:** How do they operate?
- **Notable NPCs:** Who represents or leads them?
- **Resources:** What do they control or rely on?
- **Conflicts:** Who are they struggling against?
- **Relationship to PCs:** Are they allies, enemies, or unaware?

Example:

- *Name: The Spire Cult*
- *Goals: Awaken the Flame beneath the Shudderpeaks*
- *Methods: Secret rites, stolen relics, fiery conversions*
- *Notable NPCs: High Flame Kareth, Sister Vel*
- *Resources: Hidden sanctums, touched zealots, flame idol*
- *Conflicts: Watched closely by the town clergy*
- *Relationship to PCs: Unaware, for now...*



Faction 1

Name:

Goals:

Methods:

Notable NPCs:

Resources:

Conflicts:

Relationship to PC's:

Faction 2

Name:

Goals:

Methods:

Notable NPCs:

Resources:

Conflicts:

Relationship to PC's:

Faction 3

Name:

Goals:

Methods:

Notable NPCs:

Resources:

Conflicts:

Relationship to PC's:

Faction 4

Name:

Goals:

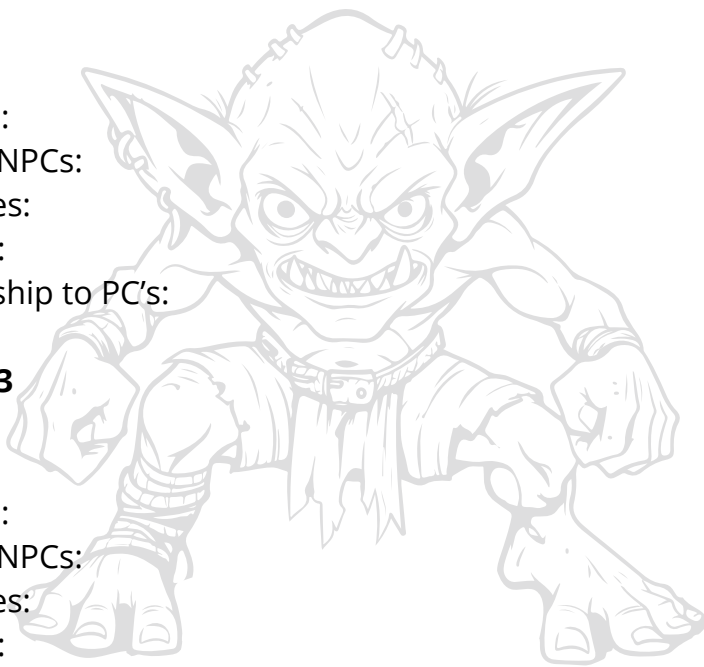
Methods:

Notable NPCs:

Resources:

Conflicts:

Relationship to PC's:



Faction 5

Name:

Goals:

Methods:

Notable NPCs:

Resources:

Conflicts:

Relationship to PC's:

Faction 6

Name:

Goals:

Methods:

Notable NPCs:

Resources:

Conflicts:

Relationship to PC's:

Faction 7

Name:

Goals:

Methods:

Notable NPCs:

Resources:

Conflicts:

Relationship to PC's:

Faction 8

Name:

Goals:

Methods:

Notable NPCs:

Resources:

Conflicts:

Relationship to PC's:



PART 8:

NPC ARCHIVE

Track notable characters the players meet, befriend, or oppose. NPCs bring the world to life, create opportunities, and complicate plans. Use this section to record their traits, goals, and relationships. NPCs like Grima (below) can start neutral, but shift allegiance based on player actions. Track these changes here.

Each NPC entry has:

- **Name:** Who are they?
- **Role:** What is their position or occupation?
- **Appearance:** Memorable physical detail or mannerism.
- **Personality:** How do they act or react?
- **Goals:** What do they want?
- **Resources:** What do they have or control?
- **Value to PCs:** Why do they matter to the party?
- **Bond to PCs:** What is their relationship with the party?

Example:

- **Name:** *Grima*
- **Role:** *Apothecary of Stonehearth*
- **Appearance:** *Ink-stained fingers, copper hair always tied back*
- **Personality:** *Dry humor, cautious with strangers*
- **Goals:** *Secure rare herbs from the Shudderpeaks*
- **Resources:** *Stocked shop, medicinal contacts in three villages*
- **Value to PCs:** *Only supplier of healing tonics around*
- **Bond to PCs:** *Slightly cautious*

NPC 1

Name:

Role:

Appearance:

Personality:

Goals:

Resources:

Value to PCs:

Bond to PCs:

NPC 2

Name:

Role:

Appearance:

Personality:

Goals:

Resources:

Value to PCs:

Bond to PCs:

NPC 3

Name:

Role:

Appearance:

Personality:

Goals:

Resources:

Value to PCs:

Bond to PCs:

NPC 4

Name:

Role:

Appearance:

Personality:

Goals:

Resources:

Value to PCs:

Bond to PCs:



NPC 5

Name:

Role:

Appearance:

Personality:

Goals:

Resources:

Value to PCs:

Bond to PCs:



NPC 6

Name:

Role:

Appearance:

Personality:

Goals:

Resources:

Value to PCs:

Bond to PCs:

NPC 7

Name:

Role:

Appearance:

Personality:

Goals:

Resources:

Value to PCs:

Bond to PCs:

NPC 8

Name:

Role:

Appearance:

Personality:

Goals:

Resources:

Value to PCs:

Bond to PCs:

NPC 9

Name:

Role:

Appearance:

Personality:

Goals:

Resources:

Value to PCs:

Bond to PCs:

NPC 10

Name:

Role:

Appearance:

Personality:

Goals:

Resources:

Value to PCs:

Bond to PCs:



PART 9:

RUMORS

Rumors plant seeds for future adventures. They can be true, partially true or even change over time. Use this section to track whispers, legends, and gossip overheard in taverns, markets, or campfires.

Each rumor entry has:

- **Source:** Who told it, or where it was heard?
- **Content:** The rumor itself.
- **Truth:** True, false, or partly true?
- **Leads:** Where it might point the PCs next.
- **Status:** Investigated, unconfirmed, or resolved.

Example:

Source: Drunken miner at The Goat's Horn tavern

Content: "The Silver Syndicate hides a vault under the old mill."

Truth: Partly true, the ruins exists, but the treasure is gone

Leads: Old ruins near Blackmoore Keep

Status: Unconfirmed

Rumor 1

Source:
Content:
Truth:
Leads:
Status:

Rumor 2

Source:
Content:
Truth:
Leads:
Status:

Rumor 3

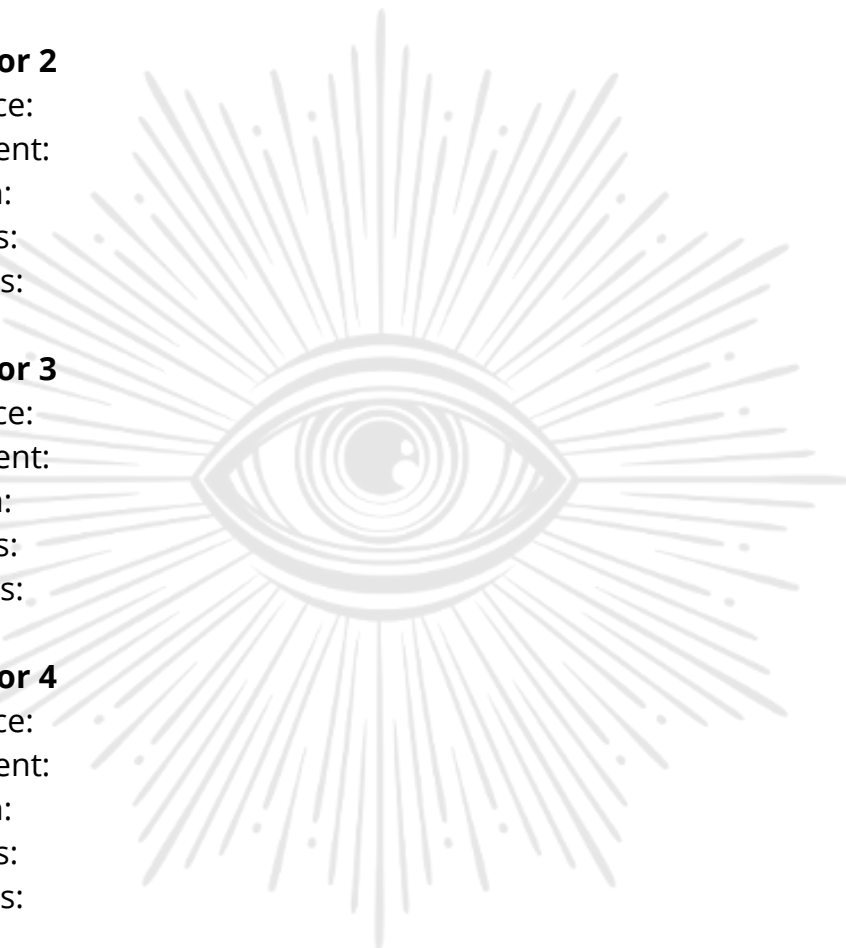
Source:
Content:
Truth:
Leads:
Status:

Rumor 4

Source:
Content:
Truth:
Leads:
Status:

Rumor 5

Source:
Content:
Truth:
Leads:
Status:



Rumor 6

Source:

Content:

Truth:

Leads:

Status:

Rumor 7

Source:

Content:

Truth:

Leads:

Status:

Rumor 8

Source:

Content:

Truth:

Leads:

Status:

Rumor 9

Source:

Content:

Truth:

Leads:

Status:

Rumor 10

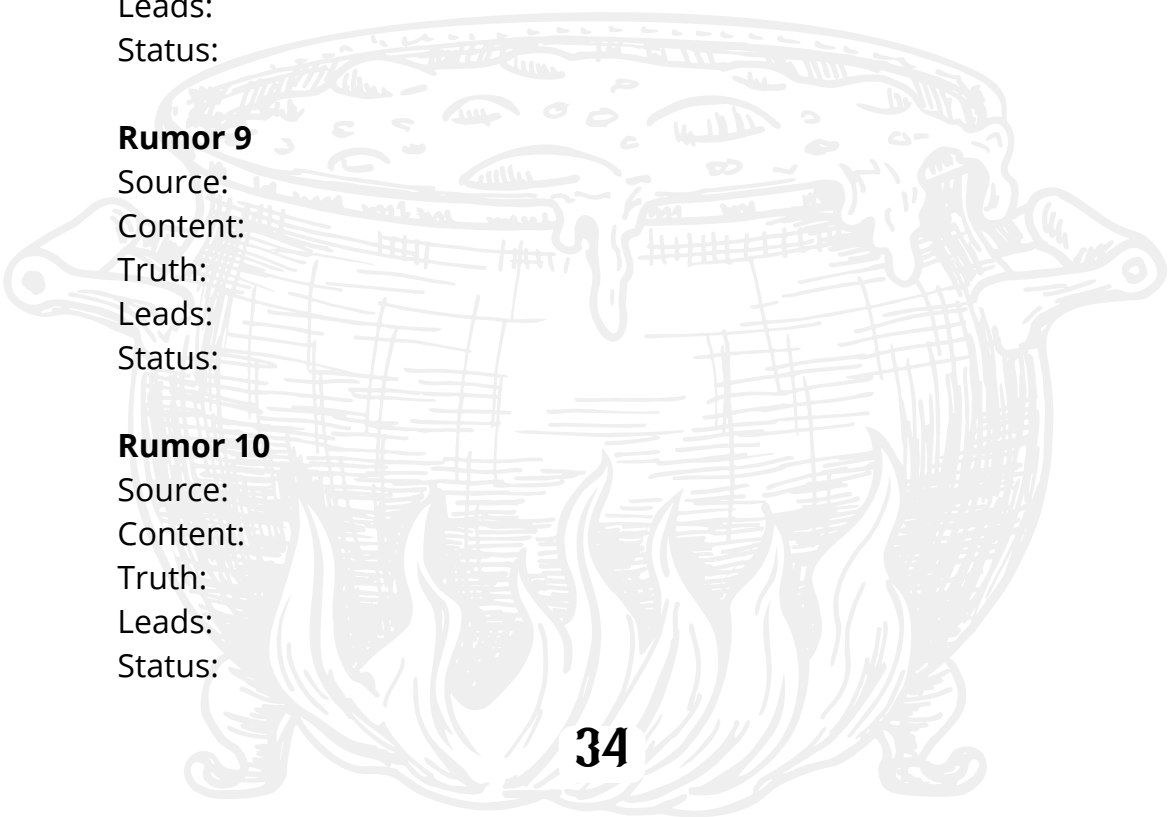
Source:

Content:

Truth:

Leads:

Status:



PART 10:

QUEST BOARD

Quests focus player attention and drive the campaign forward. They can be personal, faction-driven, or world-shaping. Use this section to note objectives, rewards, and progress.

Each quest entry has:

- **Title:** Short, evocative name.
- **Giver:** Who offered it?
- **Objective:** What must be done?
- **Obstacles:** What stands in the way?
- **Reward:** What's promised (or possible)?
- **Progress:** Steps taken or milestones reached.
- **Status:** Active, completed, or failed.

Example:

Title: *Silence the Emberwake Preacher*

Giver: *Elder Hyk*

Objective: *Stop the preacher spreading in the Shudderpeaks*

Obstacles: *Zealots, dangerous passes, hidden base*

Reward: *50 silver*

Progress: *Tracks found near the mines*

Status: *Active*

Quest 1

Title:

Giver:

Objective:

Obstacles:

Reward:

Progress:

Status:

Quest 2

Title:

Giver:

Objective:

Obstacles:

Reward:

Progress:

Status:

Quest 3

Title:

Giver:

Objective:

Obstacles:

Reward:

Progress:

Status:

Quest 4

Title:

Giver:

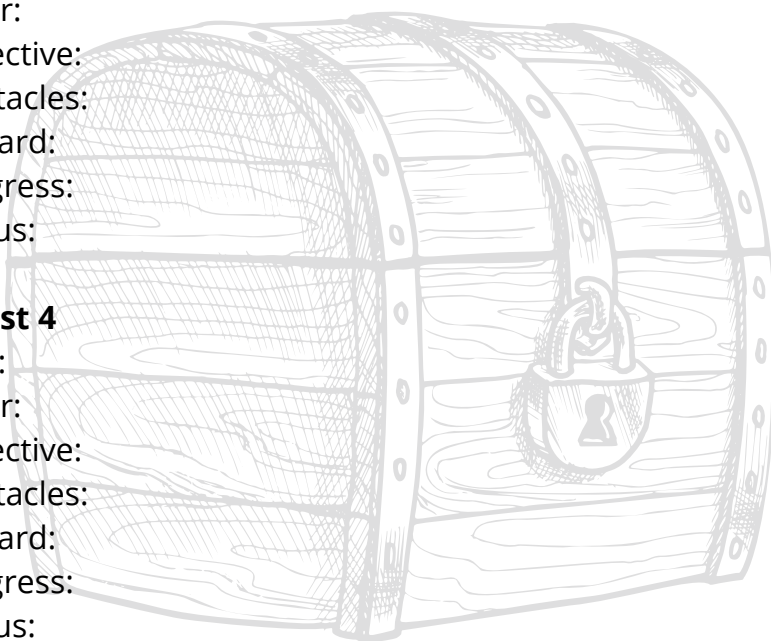
Objective:

Obstacles:

Reward:

Progress:

Status:



Quest 5

Title:

Giver:

Objective:

Obstacles:

Reward:

Progress:

Status:

Quest 6

Title:

Giver:

Objective:

Obstacles:

Reward:

Progress:

Status:

Quest 7

Title:

Giver:

Objective:

Obstacles:

Reward:

Progress:

Status:

Quest 8

Title:

Giver:

Objective:

Obstacles:

Reward:

Progress:

Status:

Quest 9

Title:

Giver:

Objective:

Obstacles:

Reward:

Progress:

Status:

Quest 10

Title:

Giver:

Objective:

Obstacles:

Reward:

Progress:

Status:



PART 11:

SESSION LOGS

Use this structure every time you run a session. This three-part cycle of preparation, session, and Downtime helps you stay focused.

You'll be ready when the session starts, you'll capture what actually happens during play, and you'll track what players do between sessions.

Keep it light, stay responsive, and let the world evolve one session at a time.

- **SESSION #:** Add the session number and name, plus the in-game date or season if you're tracking time. Real-world dates can also help organize notes.
- **PREP:** List where players are going, rumors that matter, factions in motion, and likely dangers or complications.
- **SESSION:** Write down what actually happened—important choices, scenes, new NPCs, and what changed.
- **DOWNTIME:** Note what each player did during downtime. Did they craft, heal, make deals, spy, train, or stir up trouble?

Example:

SESSION X: THE WHISPERING HILLS

Late Bloom, 3rd moon (August 5, 2025)

- **PREP:** Area, Rumors, Factions, Challenges

Reports from the Shudderpeaks say miners are vanishing near the tunnels where silver is mined. Burned bodies have been found on the trail. Town elder Hyk warns that something ancient has begun to stir. A fire preacher was seen heading west, and word spreads that a village has started “cleansing rituals.”

Possible dangers: Crumbling paths, thick fog, ritual of fire cleansing, fire followers

- **SESSION:** Key Moments, Events, NPCs

The group left Stonehearth at first light, reaching the Shudderpeaks just as the mist began to rise. They climbed the switchbacks to the silver mines and found the bodies of two miners. They were charred, mouths agape and lungs likely scorched from within. Inside the mine, they found evidence of a gathering: scattered ash circles, smudged chalk symbols, and a faint smell of smoke. No enemies were encountered, but the signs were fresh. Henna recovered a scorched scrap of parchment marked with a fiery rune.

- **DOWNTIME:** Player Actions, Results, Upgrades

Nira consulted Grima about the parchment, it's a ritual glyph. Brum helped bury the remains of the dead miners. Henna mapped the upper tunnels and noted signs of deeper excavation.

SESSION 1

PREP: Area, Rumors, Factions, Challenges

SESSION: Key Moments, Events, NPCs

DOWNTIME: Player Actions, Results, Upgrades



SESSION 2

PREP: Area, Rumors, Factions, Challenges

SESSION: Key Moments, Events, NPCs

DOWNTIME: Player Actions, Results, Upgrades



SESSION 3

PREP: Area, Rumors, Factions, Challenges

SESSION: Key Moments, Events, NPCs

DOWNTIME: Player Actions, Results, Upgrades



SESSION 4

PREP: Area, Rumors, Factions, Challenges

SESSION: Key Moments, Events, NPCs

DOWNTIME: Player Actions, Results, Upgrades



SESSION 5

PREP: Area, Rumors, Factions, Challenges

SESSION: Key Moments, Events, NPCs

DOWNTIME: Player Actions, Results, Upgrades



SESSION 6

PREP: Area, Rumors, Factions, Challenges

SESSION: Key Moments, Events, NPCs

DOWNTIME: Player Actions, Results, Upgrades



SESSION 7

PREP: Area, Rumors, Factions, Challenges

SESSION: Key Moments, Events, NPCs

DOWNTIME: Player Actions, Results, Upgrades



SESSION 8

PREP: Area, Rumors, Factions, Challenges

SESSION: Key Moments, Events, NPCs

DOWNTIME: Player Actions, Results, Upgrades



SESSION 9

PREP: Area, Rumors, Factions, Challenges

SESSION: Key Moments, Events, NPCs

DOWNTIME: Player Actions, Results, Upgrades



SESSION 10

PREP: Area, Rumors, Factions, Challenges

SESSION: Key Moments, Events, NPCs

DOWNTIME: Player Actions, Results, Upgrades



PART 12:

CALENDAR

The calendar keeps your events, quests, and world changes anchored. Whether you're marking in-game seasons, noting how long it takes for factions to react, or simply logging real-world session dates, this is where it all lines up.

Use this part to:

- **Log sessions:** Note when you played and key outcomes
- **Track in-game days & seasons:** Note the current day, season, or notable changes in time
- **Note major events:** Mark big shifts like festivals, disasters, or major discoveries

Example:

SESSIONS:	25 JUNE, SESSION 0. 4 PLAYERS, ESTABLISH WORLD BASELINE	3 JULY, SESSION 1. 3 PLAYERS, EXPLORED BRAMBLEDEEP	17 JULY, SESSION 2. 5 PLAYERS, DISEASE SPREADING			
IN-GAME:	EARLY AUTUMN. 14TH DAY, HARVEST FESTIVAL BEGINS	LATE AUTUMN, 3RD DAY, ROYAL WEDDING				
EVENTS:	VILLAGE FIRE DESTROYS THREE HOMES	PLAGUE OUTBREAK, BOTH ANIMALS AND PEOPLE DIE	ROYAL DECREE BANS MAGIC WITHIN CITY WALLS	VOLCANIC ASH DARKENS THE SKIES FOR A WEEK		

